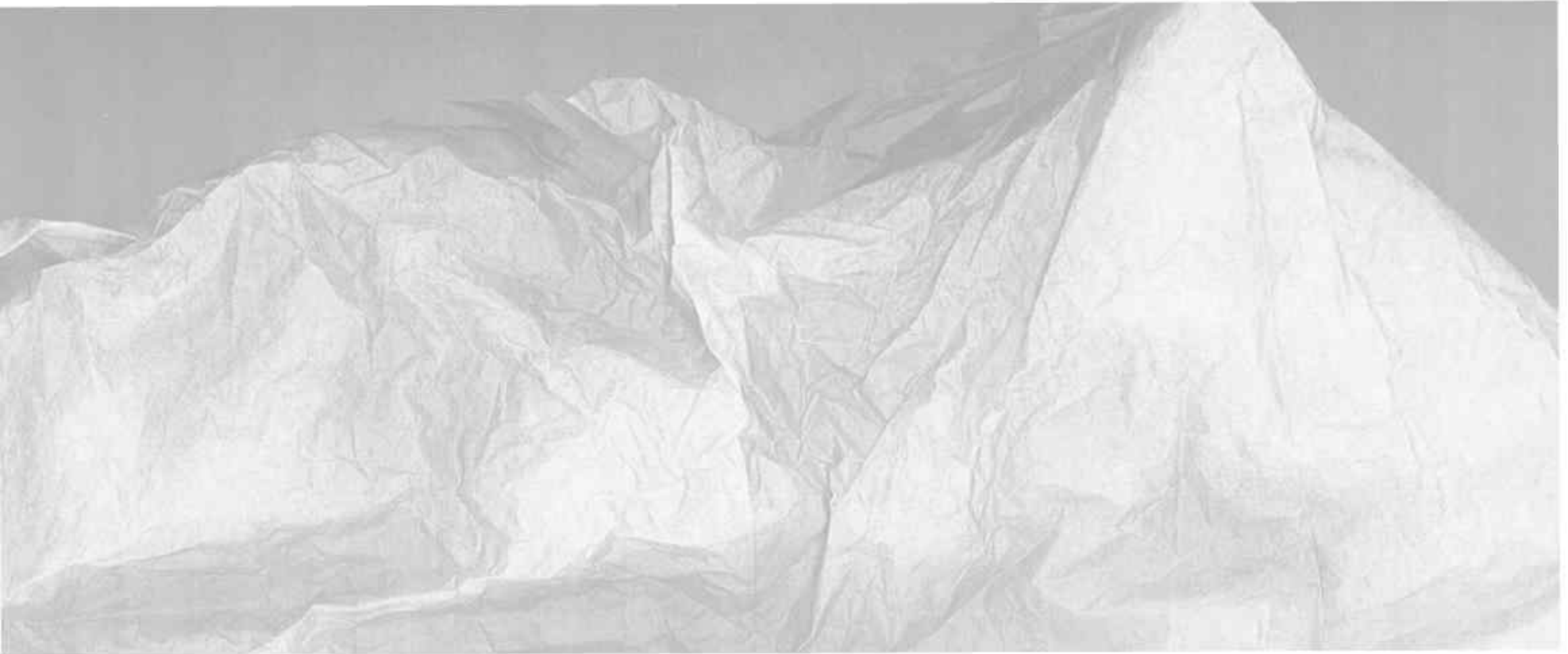


COMPETITION PAUL SMITH

MARKET RESEARCH REPORT



WILLIAM GRUBB
N0936814
FASHION DESIGN BA
2024/25

COMPETITOR ONE : THE NORTH FACE

BRAND OVERVIEW

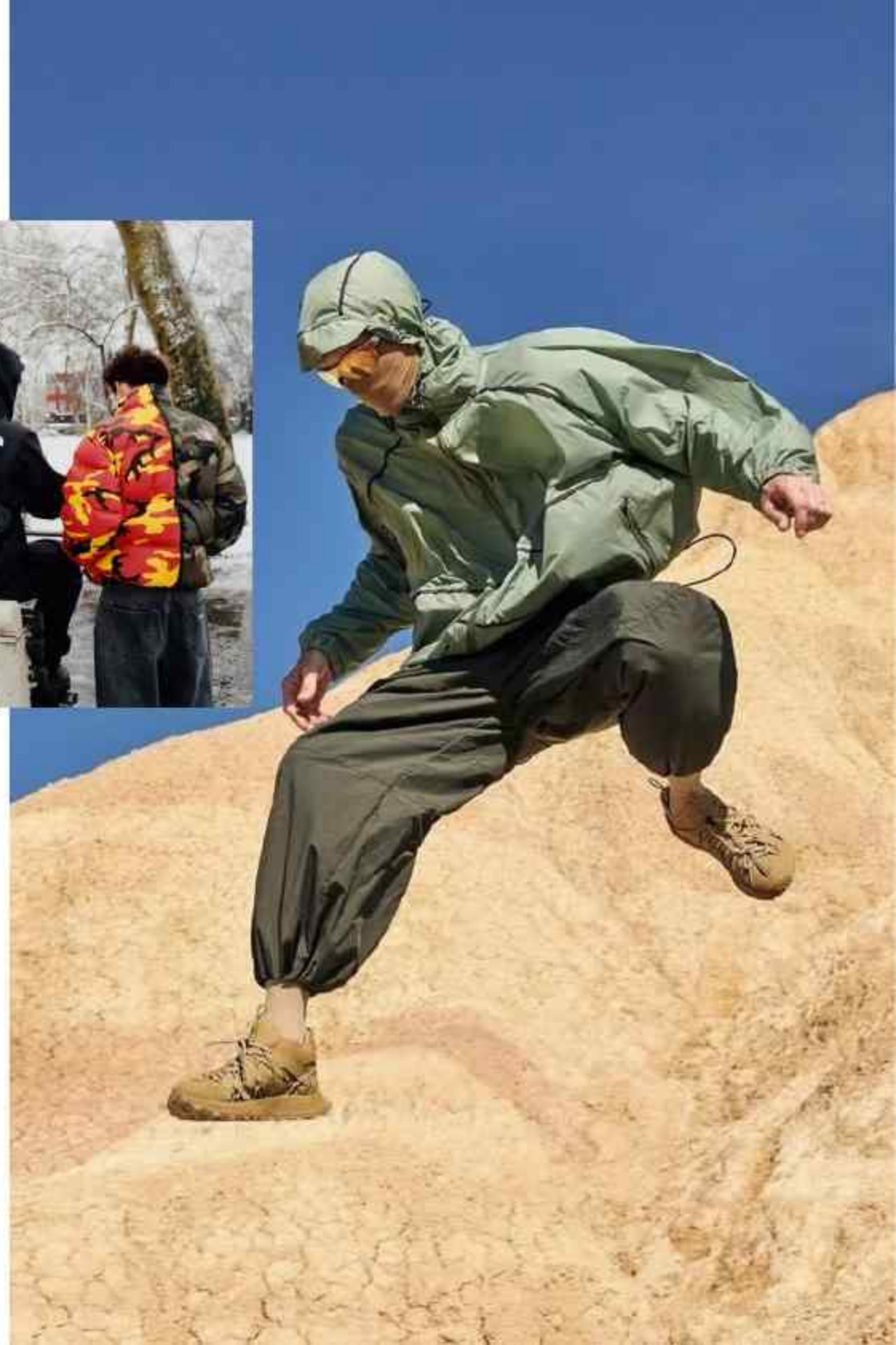
The North Face is a globally recognized outdoor apparel and equipment brand founded in 1966. Known for high-performance gear designed to withstand extreme weather conditions, it has evolved into a hybrid of technical outdoor wear and urban fashion. The brand appeals to explorers, athletes, and streetwear consumers alike, positioning itself at the intersection of function and style.



THIER USP

Unique Selling Proposition (USP)

The North Face's USP is its ability to combine extreme outdoor performance with urban style appeal. It's trusted by mountaineers and everyday commuters alike. Known for pioneering technical innovation—such as GORE-TEX outerwear and ThermoBall insulation—the brand consistently delivers durable, weather-resistant gear while maintaining street-level fashion relevance through strategic collaborations and seasonal releases.





Get 30% off this item

Men's 1998 Retro Nuptse Jacket

£189.00 - £325.00



Get 30% off this item

Men's Cedar Canvas Loose Work Trousers

£100.00



Unisex NSE Vest

£135.00



Men's Seasonal Mountain Jacket

£105.00

CUSTOMER PROFILE

Demographic:

Ages 18-40, both genders, active lifestyle, middle-income to premium buyers

Lifestyle & Interests:

Outdoor enthusiasts, urban explorers, hikers, students, creatives, fashion-conscious consumers

Style & Preferences:

Practical but trendy, prefers versatile clothing suitable for both city and nature. Looks for comfort, weather protection, and brand reputation

Values & Buying Behaviours:

Seeks quality and functionality, open to collaborations and limited drops, loyal to iconic outdoor brands, influenced by both technical specs and fashion aesthetics

PRICE POINT

The North Face occupies a mid-to-high price tier. While it's more accessible than some technical brands, the pricing still reflects quality and innovation. Jackets range from £120 to £350+, with high-performance pieces and collaborations commanding premium prices. T-shirts, fleeces, and accessories start from £30-£100. Customers are paying for performance, durability, and a trusted name.

COMPETITOR TWO : OAKLEY



BRAND OVERVIEW

Oakley, founded in 1975, is an American brand known for its performance eyewear, technical sports gear, and street-ready apparel. Originally focused on motocross and cycling, Oakley has since expanded into broader sport and lifestyle markets. The brand is recognized for pushing boundaries in optical technology, design innovation, and athlete-driven product development.



THIER USP

Oakley's USP lies in its cutting-edge lens technology (such as PRIZM™), ergonomic designs, and deep roots in action sports. The brand uniquely blends science and sport, offering precision-engineered gear that enhances athletic performance while also making bold fashion statements. Oakley is trusted by elite athletes yet remains culturally relevant through its futuristic, standout aesthetic.

CUSTOMER PROFILE

Demographic

Ages 16-40, active individuals, predominantly male, mid to high-income bracket

Lifestyle & Interests:

Action sports (cycling, skateboarding, snowboarding, golf), gym-goers, outdoor adventurers, motorsport fans, and streetwear followers.

Style & Preferences:

Performance-driven, bold and futuristic aesthetic. Prefers products that combine innovation with standout design.

Often brand loyal and tech-conscious.

Values & Buying Behaviours

Seeks durability, precision, and uniqueness. Interested in gear that boosts performance but also reflects individual style. Responsive to athlete endorsements, product tech, and limited edition drops.



NEW

Latitude Flight Wind Jacket

2 Colors

£280.00



Vista Full Zip Rc Jacket

2 Colors

£101.50 £145.00 -30%



NEW

Outdoor Hoodie

3 Colors

£77.00

PRICE POINT

Oakley is positioned in the premium price range for performance eyewear and technical gear.

- Sunglasses: £100-£250+
- Apparel: £40-£150
- Accessories: £20-£100

Prices reflect investment in high-quality materials, patented technologies, and sports innovation. Consumers are paying for performance, brand prestige, and standout design.



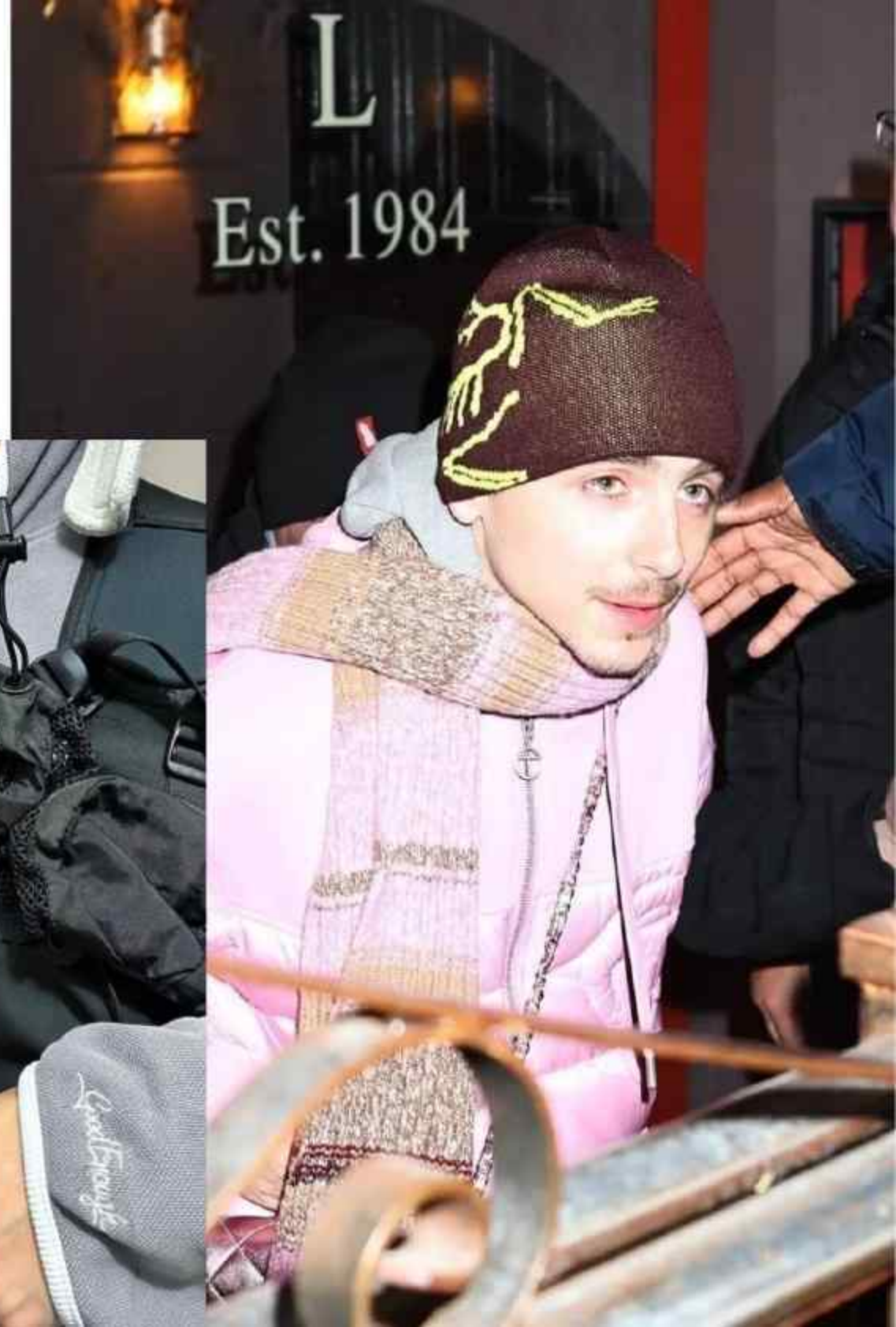
COMPETITION THREE : ARC'TERYX

BRAND OVERVIEW

Arc'teryx is a Canadian outdoor performance brand, founded in 1989 and based in North Vancouver. Renowned for its technical outerwear, climbing gear, and minimalist design, the brand has become a benchmark in both outdoor adventure circles and urban fashion. Originally built for alpine sports and extreme environments, Arc'teryx now blends function with style, appealing to outdoor athletes and streetwear enthusiasts alike.

THEIR USP

Arc'teryx stands out for its cutting-edge materials, precision construction, and purpose-driven innovation. With in-house manufacturing and rigorous testing in the rugged landscapes of British Columbia, their USP is ultra-durable, weather-proof performance gear that doesn't compromise on comfort or aesthetic. The brand's minimalist style paired with technical superiority appeals to both climbers and fashion-forward consumers.





New colour Best seller



Cerium Hoody Men's

Lightweight, warm, versatile down hoody

\$400.00



New colour Fair Trade Certified



Beta Jacket Men's

GORE-TEX ePE shell made for maximum versatility

\$400.00



Exclusive



NEW

Alpha SL 30 Backpack

Ultralight, ultra-durable 30L climbing pack

\$400.00



NEW

Kragg SL Cotton Shirt SS Men's

Soft cotton climbing tee

\$60.00



PRICE POINT

Demographic:

Typically aged 25-45, urban professionals, athletes, creatives, and outdoor enthusiasts. Mid-to-high income range, often willing to invest in quality.

Lifestyle & Interests

Hiking, mountaineering, urban exploration, technical fashion, sustainability. They often blend active lifestyles with a keen interest in design and innovation.

Style & Preferences

Minimalist, functional, and detail oriented. Prefers gear that can transition from mountain to city. Favors performance tech with a subtle, sleek look over bold branding.

Values & Buying Behaviours

Values durability, sustainability, and cutting-edge performance. Willing to pay more for long-lasting, versatile products. Responds well to transparent production ethics, craftsmanship, and products tested in real-world extreme conditions.

CUSTOMER PROFILE

Arc'teryx is positioned in the premium to luxury outdoor market.

- Shell jackets: £300-£800
- Mid-layers/fleece: £120-£300
- Pants and accessories: £100-£250

Price reflects the brand's high-performance standards, innovation in material technology (like GORE-TEX Pro), and functional design. Consumers view purchases as long-term investments.



CONCLUSION

To summarise my research, the brands I have looked at as competitors have all come from an outdoorsy background and have moved into a more streetwear market. These brands have been very true to their roots still making their original designs and have keep their high quality that was so appealing to their original customers. These brands all use earthy and subtle colour pallets often using some prints to stand out. Detailing is important to all these brands. My products would need to be made of high-quality materials and have features like waterproof and warmth. The price range would be around £ 50-150. I believe I have created a outdoorsy, functional collection that concludes my research.

